

Greg's Gossip

By L. H. Gregory

Sports Editor, The Oregonian

HE DIDN'T COACH at third base here Monday night, his new coach, Harry (Pearuts) Lowery, major and Coast league veteran lately manager for Idaho Falls in the Pioneer league, doing that chore for the Phillies. But Gene Mauch, the Philadelphia manager, until Lou Boudreau took over the Chicago Cubs recently, was the only major league chief who gets off the bench to do his own third base coaching.

"And I haven't quit it permanently, though Lowery, a coach of fine judgment on when to send a runner in, will be there much of the time from now on," said Mauch. "I like to be out there now and then, for it gives me the real 'feel' of the game."

"I'd say the reason major league managers so seldom appear on the third base line any more is that it puts them too much on the spot. No matter who the third base coach is, he'll make mistakes, and managers don't enjoy the razzing that follows. I can take that. However, it's also true that a manager must be thinking several plays ahead, both offensively and defensively — what relief pitcher to use, for instance, what pinch hitter to put in. Most managers, and they're probably right, think they can do that better from the bench. But I do like to be out there myself."

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"HOW DO I LIKE managing in the majors? I love it!" added Mauch, who managed one year at Atlanta and two at Minneapolis, always with first division finishes, before being called to the Phillies. "There are problems, of course. That of rebuilding from a lowly position, such as ours is now, is a big one."

"However, I feel absolutely certain that I can improve the position of our club and eventually be up in the pennant race. It will take time and patience and require looking over and passing judgment on a great number of players."

"I have, however, the best man in the majors to work with in Bobby Quinn as general manager. It was Quinn, you know, who built up the Boston Braves to their present pre-eminence as the Milwaukee Braves. He backs me in every step."

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WE HAD A CHAT with Bobby Gene Smith, the Hood River boy who did such a territory-covering job for the Phillies Tuesday night in center field — seven chances, not all of them easy. He loves being in the majors, too—says



ANDY COHEN

16 Seasons as manager

there's an unbelievable difference between playing with a major league club and one of the top minors. The Phils got him in trade from St. Louis, where he played two years. While they're using him principally now as pinch hitter against southpaws, or as fielding insurance in the last couple of innings, his place with the Phillies this season is secure.

By the way, they don't use that full name, Bobby Gene Smith, for him in Philadelphia, but have shortened it to his initials. He's called "B. G. Smith" now, his name going that way even into box scores. We wondered how it happened that he was originally called Bobby Gene Smith?

"When I joined the Cardinals in 1957," Bobby Gene smilingly explained, "there already were four Smiths with the club, and I made the fifth. There was Bob Smith, a southpaw pitcher from San Francisco, who usually is called 'R. G.'. There were Hal Smith, a catcher, and Milt Smith, a third baseman. And there was Willard Schmidt, also a pitcher—not quite a 'Smith', but close enough to cause confusion. Then I came and identification of which of the Smiths was which became a problem."

"I had been known as 'Smitty' with other clubs, but that wouldn't do with four others answering to the designation. So someone started calling me 'Bobby Gene', and it stuck. With the Phillies we don't have that Smith problem, and 'Bobby Gene' is a bit long, hence the switch to 'B. G.'. But I don't care what they call me if they just let me play."

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ANOTHER, to us, very interesting member of the Phil-

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